

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



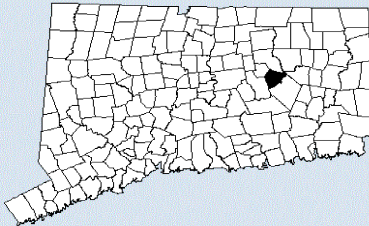
Columbia School District

Maria Geryk, Superintendent • 860-228-9493 • <http://www.hwporter.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-8
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	402
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,132
Total Expenditures ¹	\$12,301,640

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	6

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	179	44.5	48.4
Male	223	55.5	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	6	1.5	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	27	6.7	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	18	4.5	4.0
White	348	86.6	49.9
English Learners	*	*	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	91	22.6	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	44	10.9	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	11	6.2	0	0.0
Male	25	11.3	10	4.2
Black or African American	*	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	0	0.0
White	23	6.7	10	2.7
English Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	16	20.5	*	*
Students with Disabilities	8	17.8	*	*
District	36	9.0	10	2.3
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 0

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Columbia School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	34.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	6.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	4.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	10.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	2.0
School Level	2.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	1.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	6.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	3.0
School Nurses	1.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	32.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1	1.9	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	52	98.1	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	2.6	7.3

Instruction and Resources

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*
Emotional Disturbance	*	*
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	20	80.0
Other Health Impairment	21	95.5
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	*	*
District	52	81.3
State		67.9

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Columbia School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.5
Learning Disability	25	4.1	5.8
Other Health Impairment	22	3.6	3.3
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	*	*	1.9
All Disabilities	64	10.4	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$7,530,158	\$11,711	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$1,996,185	\$4,893	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$104,377	\$256	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$520,515	\$1,276	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$541,425	\$1,327	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$132,852	\$326	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$467,734	\$1,146	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$636,914	\$989	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$371,480	\$910	\$151
Total	\$12,301,640	\$19,132	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$890,394	31.6	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$332,307	11.8	11.1
Other Salaries	\$241,197	8.6	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$383,189	13.6	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$81,254	2.9	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$710,647	25.3	22.5
Supplies	\$6,888	0.2	0.5
Property Services	.	.	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$154,057	5.5	7.2
Equipment	\$14,300	0.5	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$2,814,233	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		22.9	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	77.7
State	20.3
Federal	1.7
Tuition & Other	0.3

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Columbia School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
READING	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Columbia School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	9.0%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	18.9%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	N/A	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		87.8%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		.	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		.	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		.	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		.	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	.

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Columbia School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Columbia School District and Horace W. Porter School are dedicated to the continuous improvement of our multi-tiered system of educational programming provided to all students. The district improvement plan outlines the mission, vision, core values and guiding principles established by the broader educational community and provides a road map to meet these expectations. Through analysis of multiple data points and progress to date, the plan is modified yearly to adapt and adjust to the changing student needs. The goal areas and strategies identified focus on strengthening the systems and structures essential to provide embedded professional development; strengthening and aligning a model of high-quality instruction, standards-based curriculum, assessment, and interventions; to create a comprehensive framework to ensure a positive learning environment and to improve school-wide climate; and strengthening two-way communication with staff, students, families and the broader community. The continuous improvement plan drives all initiatives and the budget process.

Renewal of curricular programs aligned with the Common Core State Standards continues as a priority for Porter School. Evidence based programs are being implemented to meet the needs of our students in the area of mathematics, English Language Arts, science, health, and technology. Review of social studies curricular needs are underway. In addition, focus is maintained to strengthen our Scientific Research-Based Instruction Model, including the routine application of a student support team process where academic, social, emotional, attendance, and behavioral needs are reviewed, and interventions prescribed. Essential to continuous improvement, instructional coaches and interventionists are in place for Porter School.

We are entering our third year of implementation of a school-wide approach to positive behavioral intervention and support. In addition, we are entering our second year of implementation of a social emotional learning curriculum taught at all grade levels.

Our commitment is to meet the needs of all Columbia students. Special Education services are provided for those identified students based on their individual needs. We currently maintain two full day integrated preschool programs, and a broad range of service providers and specialists are in place to provide identified specialized instruction in the least restrictive setting.

Increasing systemic family engagement continues to be a priority for Columbia. While there is a strong Porter Parent Organization in place, leveraging family input and student voice to inform school improvement efforts is an area of focus. Various methods of sharing information through the use of Facebook, newsletters, routine updates, school messenger, and creation of a new website is in place.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Columbia School District is focusing on efforts to reduce racial, ethnic and economic isolation by striving to provide an equitable school district for all students. We are actively exploring and addressing barriers to equitable student access, participation, and benefit in all programs and services. Data was analyzed to identify and address achievement gaps in academic performance, discipline data, and attendance.

We are continuously strengthening our instructional practices, interventions, and enrichment to be more equitable. Curricular materials are chosen to ensure they are effective with our student populations, and that material and content are representative of students in our global world. For example, last year the district adopted a new ELA program. Cultural representation and relevance were strong considerations in our selection process and the new program integrates global perspectives, and a diverse range of authors and texts. We also began redesigning our middle school Social Studies curriculum, with increased cultural relevance as one of our goals in this work.

Other experiences and activities are designed to increase student awareness of the diversity of individuals and cultures. Porter School is dedicated to cultivating an understanding and respect for diverse populations, abilities, and perspectives. Porter school staff and other area providers (AHM Youth and Family Services) create opportunities for our students to learn and apply skills in problem solving, restorative processes, leadership, mentoring, empathy, and respect. This past year, AHM brought in a facilitator to address issues related to stress and peer relationships for our grade eight students. The "Wingman Experience" was brought in for our students in grades six and seven. The overarching themes of this program are community-building, respect, inclusion, and a celebration of our unique selves. Finally, SERC (State Education Resource Center) conducted focus groups with our grade five students to address topics of identity, culture, race, bias, and equity. We will be expanding this work in the upcoming school year to support middle school students in developing their leadership abilities and to strengthen the Porter School community.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Columbia School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Columbia is a single-school preschool through grade 8 district that provides for students in grades 9-12 to attend three high schools (Bolton, EO Smith and Windham Tech.) based solely on choice. Resources are allocated based on where students chose to attend school, and therefore is a fixed cost for our district.

Classroom teachers and other professionals develop budget requests for Porter School which are submitted to administration. After administrative and BOE review, the approved budget is reviewed by the town's finance board. The recommended budget is presented at an Annual Town meeting for approval. The Board of Education goals represented through the Continuous Improvement Plan are the basis for budget development and implementation.